

Advertisement

AI's talent arms race is starting to look like pro sports

Rebecca Bellan, Theresa Loconsolo — Jul 23, 2025



AI is entering a new phase where access to top talent is becoming as important as, if not more

important than, compute or data. The market for AI researchers is so overheated, it's starting to look a lot like pro sports — complete with outsized contracts and unprecedented infrastructure needs.

On today's episode of [Equity](#), Rebecca Bellan chatted with [Deedy Das](#), principal at Menlo Ventures. Das has seen this shift from multiple angles, first as an engineer and product leader at Google, Facebook, and AI startup Glean, and now as an investor helping technical founders figure out how to build enduring companies in this new AI landscape.

TE DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

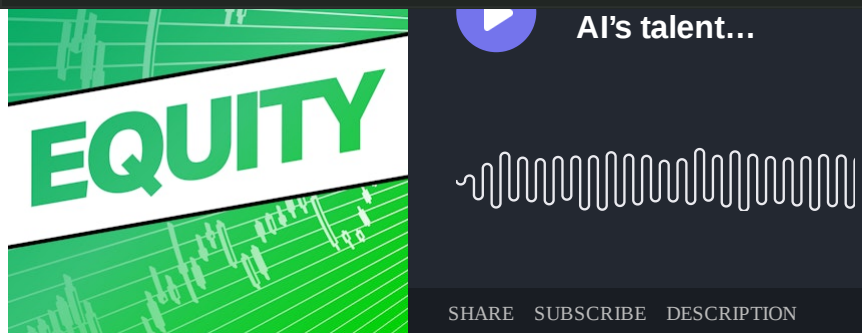
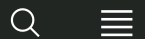
Most

Latest
Startups
Venture
Apple

Security
AI
Apps

TE

Events
Podcasts
Newsletters



generated ad isn't just about fashion

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps

Listen to the full episode to hear:

- Why Meta is spending billions on both [compute](#) and [researchers](#).

- How [compensation packages and acquisitions](#) are warping startup hiring and retention.
- What motivates top researchers to leave, even when they've already made millions.
- How VCs are thinking about key-person risk in the AI era.

Equity will be back Friday with our weekly news roundup, so stay tuned.

Equity is TechCrunch's flagship podcast, produced by Theresa Loconsolo, and posts every Wednesday and Friday. Subscribe to us on [Apple Podcasts](#), [Overcast](#), [Spotify](#) and all the casts. You also can follow Equity on [X](#) and [Threads](#), at [@EquityPod](#).



Rebecca Bellan

Senior Reporter |

Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, where she covers Tesla and Elon Musk's broader...

[View Bio](#) >



Theresa Loconsolo

Audio Producer |

Theresa Loconsolo is an audio producer at TechCrunch focusing on Equity, the network's flagship podcast....

[View Bio](#) >

Latest Equity Episodes

[See More](#)



STARTUPS

 **Figma's IPO success is 'a little bit of a meme stock,' says Sapphire Ventures' Jai Das**

Rebecca Bellan,
Theresa Loconsolo
- 12 hours ago



AI

 **From Meta's massive offers to Anthropic's massive valuation, does AI have a ceiling?**

Theresa Loconsolo,
Anthony Ha,
Kirsten Korosec,
Maxwell Zeff
- Aug 1, 2025



AI

 **What's the real cost of chasing AGI? Power consolidation is just the start, says the AI Now Institute.**

Theresa Loconsolo,
Rebecca Bellan
- Jul 31, 2025



AI

 **Should Silicon Valley celebrate Trump's AI plans?**

Anthony Ha,
Theresa Loconsolo,
Kirsten Korosec,
Maxwell Zeff
- Jul 25, 2025



TechCrunch
Staff

Contact Us

Advertise

Crunchboard
Jobs

Site Map

Terms of
Service

Privacy
Policy

RSS Terms of
Use

OpenAI
Perplexity

Cisco
DeepMind

Windsurf
Tech Layoffs
ChatGPT